A large pure alternating prefix at a later orbit cut

Human Compression project: L044 continuation

Lemma 1 (An attached prefix near half its degree)**.** *Let $P = \langle s_0, \dots, s_{d-1} \rangle \le \mathrm{Alt}(C)$ be a transitive string C-group on $c = |C|$ points, with all maximal omissions intransitive and an anchor at its last endpoint. Suppose*

$$d \ge c/2 - 1, \qquad d \ge 5, \qquad \mathrm{Alt}(W) \le \langle s_0, \dots, s_4 \rangle, \quad |W| \ge 8,$$

where $\mathrm{Alt}(W)$ is the actual natural group fixing $C \setminus W$. Then $P = \mathrm{Alt}(C)$ naturally.

Proof. Suppose first that P preserves a nontrivial equal-block system, with block size $a \ge 2$ and block number $b \ge 2$. The natural $\mathrm{Alt}(W)$ preserves that system. If a block meets W and its complement, an outside point is fixed by $\mathrm{Alt}(W)$, so its block is invariant and contains all of W. If no such mixed block occurs, the blocks meeting W partition W and are invariant as a system under its primitive natural alternating action. They are either singletons or one block. Singleton blocks contradict $a \ge 2$. In all cases some block contains W, giving $a \ge 8$.

The complete accepted actual-orbit forest and Whiston argument for an anchored imprimitive interval gives $d \le a + b - 2$. This inequality uses the actual omission condition; it does not assign IP to the block quotient. If $b \ge 3$, then

$$\frac{ab}{2} - 1 - (a + b - 2) = \frac{(a-2)(b-2) - 2}{2} > 0,$$

contradicting $d \ge c/2 - 1$. If $b = 2$, all generators except s_{d-1} fix the anchor point, so preserve both blocks. Transitivity forces s_{d-1} to exchange them. Here $d \ge a - 1 \ge 7$, so the string condition makes s_{d-1} commute with every generator of $\langle s_0, \dots, s_4 \rangle$ and hence with $\mathrm{Alt}(W)$. It must preserve the latter's unique nontrivial orbit W. This is incompatible with exchanging the two blocks, one of which contains W. Thus P is primitive.

For completeness, a primitive permutation group containing a natural alternating group on at least three points contains the whole natural alternating group. Consider all conjugate supports W^g, $g \in P$. They cover C. Two intersecting supports can be merged: if they meet in at least two points, their pure three-cycles generate the alternating group on the union. If they meet only at p, choose distinct u, v in the first support other than p, and a three-cycle in the second taking p to z. Conjugating $(p\ u\ v)$ gives $(z\ u\ v)$. This first merges z into the first support, after which the intersection has two points and the preceding argument applies. The unions of connected components of the support-intersection graph therefore form blocks for P, each of size at least three. Primitivity gives one component, and the generated pure alternating group is $\mathrm{Alt}(C)$. Since $P \le \mathrm{Alt}(C)$, equality follows. □

Theorem 2 (The side containing the exceptional head)**.** *Retain the complete L044 standing hypotheses and smaller-degree alternating induction: $G \le A_n$, $n \ge 12$, is transitive with connected string C-marking, and every maximal omission is intransitive. Assume rank failure $r > \lfloor (n-1)/2 \rfloor$, and the actual first three generators are an extendable source Table 2(2) or (3) head on $D = \{1, \dots, 6\}$. Let $j \ge 5$ have a unique eligible crossing, and suppose its omission has two orbits C, F with actual supported transitive sides*

$$P = G_{<j} \text{ on } C, \qquad Q = G_{>j} \text{ on } F, \qquad D \subseteq C.$$

The suffix is allowed to be trivial when F is a singleton. Then $P = \mathrm{Alt}(C)$ naturally.

Proof. The accepted critical-head reduction gives, with $E = \Omega \setminus D$,

$$\tau = \rho_3 = (6\ b)\delta, \quad b \in E, \quad \mathrm{supp}(\delta) \subseteq E \setminus \{b\}, \quad G_{\geq 3} = \mathrm{Alt}(E \cup \{6\}).$$

This uses its full retained primitive, anchored and small-degree bounds and explicit induction. It does not assert that $G_{\geq 4}$ is the full alternating group on E. Put $\sigma = \rho_4$. The group $G_{\geq 5}$ fixes $6, b$. If σ fixed b, the transitive group $G_{\geq 3}$ would preserve $\{6, b\}$. Thus $x = b^\sigma \neq b$. It lies outside D, since σ fixes D pointwise. Conjugating τ by the transitive head and multiplying pairs of conjugates cancels δ and supplies pure $\mathrm{Alt}(D \cup \{b\})$ in $G_{\leq 3}$. Conjugation by σ then gives

$$\mathrm{Alt}(W) \leq G_{\leq 4}, \qquad W = D \cup \{b, x\}, \quad |W| = 8.$$

As $j \geq 5$, this group lies in P, so $W \subseteq C$.

The unique crossing supplies an anchor at the last endpoint of P and, when nontrivial, at the first endpoint of Q. Indeed all other generators on that side commute with the crossing involution and fix its other endpoint. Every local maximal omission on either side is intransitive: a transitive one, together with the entire opposite side and the crossing, would make the corresponding ambient omission transitive. Each side has connected string diagram, inherited from the full connected string.

The complete paid attached-side bounds give $\mathrm{rank}(Q) \leq |F|/2$. For degrees below 12, use the complete small attached-prefix exclusion and its full dual, not the raw Table 2 list alone. Each side here is a proper actual prefix or suffix of the ambient marking. At rank at least $(m-1)/2$, that exclusion leaves only the five-point dihedral and six-point A_5 markings, both obeying this weak bound. At lower rank the bound is immediate; the small anchored imprimitive theorem handles the other cases. For larger degrees use the proper primitive and anchored imprimitive bounds, or the explicit smaller-degree alternating induction for a full natural alternating side. A singleton has rank zero. No unanchored blanket bound is used. Since $r = j + \mathrm{rank}(Q) + 1 \geq n/2$, it follows that $j \geq |C|/2 - 1$. Apply the lemma to P, with $d = j$. □

Source route and exact limit. This handles the head-containing side at a later unshared orbit cut in the exceptional continuation of source Propositions 5.28 and 5.32 (physical pages 36–38 and 44–45). It replaces an unresolved group-identification alternative by an actual natural alternating subgroup under the displayed supported-side hypotheses. The source's cut strategy and the accepted actual-orbit forest/Whiston bound are retained; the large pure-subgroup block obstruction is the present argument. The opposite dihedral or A_5 side, crossings with shared labels, and the full source conclusion are not discarded. Every inherited proof and required finite input remains paid. No new census, formalization, original or question credit is asserted.